[INCH-POUND]
A-A-3087
October 10, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, SHEET HOLDER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description for procurement of forceps specified in GGG-F-570A for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE.

1.1 Scope. This Commercial Item Description covers sheet holder forceps used for inserting and removing sheet holders during fabrication of components from sheet metal.

2. CLASSIFICATION.

2.1 Classification. Not applicable.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

3.1 Design. The forceps shall be of steel and shall be heat treated to a hardness of 35-50 HRC. The forceps shall be designed so that the head and necked-down portion of the sheet holder will rest in counterbored seats in both jaws of the forceps. The upper and lower seats in the forceps jaws shall be designed so that the sheet holder may not accidentally slip out of the jaws and cause personal injury. A minimum jaw opening of 1 inch shall accommodate sheet holders conforming to MIL-H-795, type I, class 2, and type II, classes 2 and 3. The joint shall operate freely and smoothly without wedging or binding throughout the entire range of opening and closing. There shall be no excessive side movement, play, or other looseness when the forceps are opened or closed. The handles shall be designed to afford a comfortable grip with no rough edges or sharp corners. The forceps shall be electroplated with either nickel, zinc, or chromium. The plated surface shall be smooth and continuous. The overall length of the forceps shall be 8 inches maximum and the weight shall not exceed 9 ounces. The forceps shall be similar to Figure 1.

3.2 Load test. Each sample forcep shall have a 1/2-inch diameter by 1-inch long steel pin placed lengthwise between the jaws. A closing load of 80 pounds minimum shall be applied 1/2 inch from the end of the handles and held for a minimum of one minute. With the pin and load removed, the forceps shall be checked for operation by inserting and removing sheet holders in a manner simulating the conditions under which the forceps will be used in actual practice. Any evidence of failure or deformation shall be cause for rejection.

3.3 Identification marking. The tool shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or identifying symbol and the state or country of manufacture, unless otherwise specified. All identification markings shall be engraved, etched, molded, or indented directly on the item's surface in such a manner that it remains clearly legible throughout the life of the item.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any other data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Tools and Appliances Commodity Center, Kansas City, MO 64131.

Distribution Statement A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 5120

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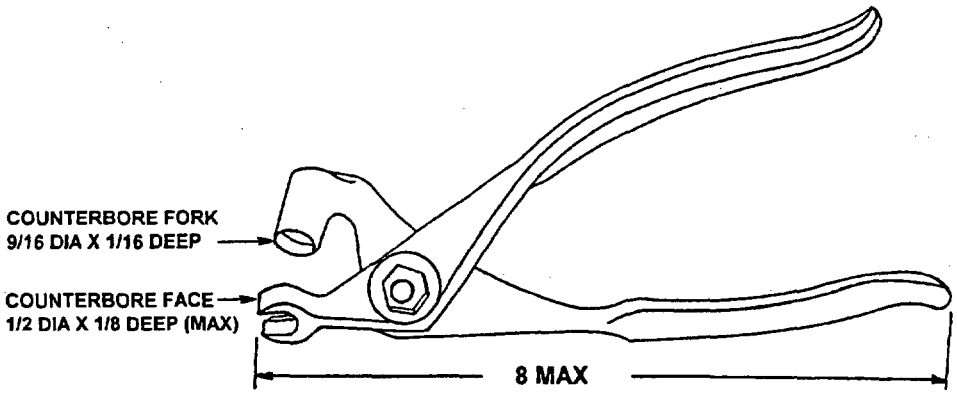


Figure 1. Forceps, sheet holder.

3.3 Workmanship. Details of workmanship shall be in accordance with the best commercial practice. Paints, coatings, platings, and finishes shall be smooth, adherent, continuous, and not stained or discolored. External surfaces shall be free of tool and gouge marks, nicks, or other surface imperfections. The item shall be free from manufacturing workmanship defects (e.g., sharp or rough external edges, corners, or surfaces) and material workmanship defects (e.g., pits, rips, fins, burrs, tears, nodules, cracks, blisters) which may adversely impact the item's serviceability, durability, safety, or appearance.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS.

4.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4.2 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified (using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376) and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

5.1 Product conformance. The product provided to the Government shall conform to the contractually specified requirements. For product characteristics and requirements which are not contractually specified, the provided product shall conform to the producer's own drawings, standards, specifications, and quality assurance practices for the highest quality product commercially offered by the producer. If the product is not commercially offered by the producer, the best commercial practices shall apply. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformances prior to first delivery and thereafter as provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements and may use any commercial facilities (including the contractor's own facilities) suitable for performance of the inspection requirements, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any inspections deemed necessary to assure the item conforms to the specified requirements.

5.3 Bid sample(s). When a bid sample requirement is specified in the solicitation, the bid sample(s) shall be inspected for all salient characteristics by the Government. A failure of any bid sample to meet the salient characteristics shall be cause for rejection.

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5.4 First article sample(s). When a first article requirement is specified in the contract, the first article sample(s) shall be inspected for all salient characteristics. A failure of any first article sample to meet the salient characteristics shall be cause for rejection.

6. PACKAGING.

6.1 Packaging. Requirements of preservation, packing, packaging, and marking of packages shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES.

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that is not mandatory.)

7.1 Addresses for obtaining copies of referenced documents:

Federal Specifications and Standards: Federal Supply Service Bureau, Specification Section, Suite 8100, 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington, DC 20407.

Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR): Government Printing Office, Superintendent of Documents, Washington, DC 20402-9371.

ANSI/ASQC Z1.4: American Society for Quality Control, P.O. Box 3005, 611 East Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 43201-4606.

DoD Standardization Documents: Standardization Document Order Desk, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and should include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
(b) When applicable, the appropriate NSN(s).
(c) If bid samples are required, the number of samples required, and the subjective inspection requirements.
(d) If first article samples are required and the number of samples required.
(e) If lot sampling inspection is required and the applicable lot sampling requirements. For example:

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection (both examinations and testing) shall be in accordance with ANSI/ASQC Z1.4.

Inspection. Each sample tool shall be examined and tested for all salient characteristics. The Inspection Level shall be S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

(f) What preservation, packing, packaging, and marking of packages are required.

7.3 National Stock Numbers (NSNs). The following list of NSNs corresponds to the forceps specified in this CID. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSNs associated with this CID.

NSN	SIZE
5120-00-221-1597	1-inch opening, 8-inch length

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions or notices to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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